



Vinitha Mahadevan

Lead Release Train Engineer · SAFe RTE · Agile Transformation Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Lead Release Train Engineer with 20+ years of experience in Agile program management, SAFe implementation, and large-scale technology delivery. Proven track record of leading multiple Agile Release Trains (ARTs) across cross-functional teams to drive end-to-end value delivery. Expert in facilitating PI Planning, removing impediments, managing dependencies, and fostering continuous improvement. Adept at leading distributed teams (onshore/offshore) and partnering with executive leadership to align program execution with strategic business objectives. Deep domain experience across automotive, healthcare, insurance, banking, retail, manufacturing, and logistics sectors.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Agile & SAFe

PI Planning, ART Execution, Scrum of Scrums, Kanban, Lean-Agile, Inspect & Adapt

Leadership

Coaching & Mentoring, Servant Leadership, Facilitation, Stakeholder Mgmt, Process Re-engineering

Program Management

Release Planning, Dependency & Risk Mgmt, Capacity Planning, Demand Mgmt, Portfolio Intake

Tools & Methodologies

Jira, Confluence, Rally, MS Project, SAFe, Scrum, Kanban, Lean Portfolio Mgmt

EXPERIENCE

Lead Release Train Engineer

Apr 2022 - Present

Cox Automotive Inc. – Roswell, GA

- Lead and coach multiple Agile Release Trains (ARTs) comprising 7+ cross-functional teams (50+ engineers), driving end-to-end delivery for the automotive retail ecosystem

- Facilitate quarterly PI Planning events with 80+ participants, aligning Product, Engineering, Architecture, and Business stakeholders on program objectives
- Drive continuous improvement through Inspect & Adapt workshops using flow metrics to identify bottlenecks and implement process improvements
- Manage cross-team dependencies, risks, and impediments; escalate strategically to executive sponsors
- Coach Scrum Masters, Product Owners, and teams on SAFe practices and Lean-Agile principles
- Establish ART-level KPIs (predictability, cycle time, throughput); present data-driven insights to leadership
- Lead transformation of traditional project teams into high-performing Agile teams

Senior Release Train Engineer

MerchantE – Alpharetta, GA

Sep 2021 – Mar 2022

- Served as RTE for payment technology solutions, facilitating ART ceremonies and cross-team coordination
- Managed program-level backlog and release planning for merchant payment processing platforms

Program Manager **Anthem, Inc. – Greater Atlanta Area** Jan 2018 – Aug 2021

- Served as Release Train Engineer for large group Underwriting project in health insurance
- Managed program execution, stakeholder reporting, and cross-team dependencies for enterprise healthcare initiatives
- Drove Agile adoption and maturity, improving delivery predictability and quality

Program Executive

Cognizant – Anthem Inc.

Mar 2016 – Dec 2017

- Led program management for Anthem account, managing delivery across multiple workstreams
- Coordinated with client leadership to align program milestones with business objectives
- Drove process improvements and governance frameworks for large-scale healthcare IT programs

Portfolio Project Manager

Cognizant Technology Solutions – Sallie Mae

Jan 2015 – Feb 2016

- Managed portfolio demand management and release delivery for student lending programs
- Mentored project managers and established standardized processes

Senior Manager **Cognizant – Express Scripts, Orlando, FL** Feb 2013 – Dec 2014

- Managed specialty pharmacy projects for Integration and Intake portfolio
- Led demand planning, forecasting, and budgeting; mentored project managers
- Drove process re-engineering for Intake to streamline delivery

Senior Manager Cognizant – Wellpoint, Richmond, VA Oct 2010 – Jan 2013

- Managed programs across multiple teams/vendors with 200+ resources
- Led business solutions development, process re-engineering, budgeting, and implementation
- Coached senior staff on planning and execution of critical business initiatives
- Developed project roadmaps, change management, risk assessment, and stakeholder reporting

Project Manager Cognizant – BCBSM, NASCO, Wellpoint Oct 2007 – Oct 2010

- Managed mid-size projects spanning multiple teams in the healthcare payer space

Senior Programmer Analyst Cognizant – WI, MI Jul 2003 – Oct 2007

- Developed technical solutions on LAWSON HR and Financials at Schneider National, WI
- Led technical teams (onsite/offshore) for claims migration at BCBSM, MI

Technical Software Consultant Deutsche Bank Jun 2000 – Jul 2003

- Developed and enhanced Corporate Banking and Investment Banking applications
- Worked across global teams (U.K., USA, Singapore, Malaysia, India)

CERTIFICATIONS

SAFe 4 Release
Train Engineer
(RTE)
Scaled Agile, Inc.
Issued Oct 2020

SAFe 4 Advanced
Scrum Master
(SASM)
Scaled Agile, Inc.
Issued Jun 2020

SAFe 4 Product
Owner/Product
Manager (POPM)
Scaled Agile, Inc.
Issued Jul 2020

KEY ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- **ART Launch & Maturation:** Launched and matured a new ART at Cox Automotive, achieving 85%+ PI predictability within three Program Increments
- **Delivery Velocity:** Improved ART delivery velocity by 30% through WIP optimization and bottleneck removal
- **Cultural Transformation:** Championed Agile adoption across waterfall-aligned teams, improving engagement and time-to-market
- **Dependency Management:** Implemented visual dependency tracking that reduced cross-team blocking issues by 40%
- **Executive Reporting:** Designed metrics-driven dashboard providing real-time ART health and risk visibility

EDUCATION

University of Madras, Chennai – Bachelor of Engineering, Electrical, Electronics and Communications Engineering

